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Senior Game Designer

19 years experience designing and developing games with a large focus on casual and mobile.

Developed games from concept to global launch and live ops.

Worked across disciplines and with all stakeholders at various levels of seniority to align on goals.

Comfortable driving projects of various sizes, having worked with teams from 3 to 50 and beyond including collaborating with remote outsourced studios and contracted talent.

Regularly organize 1-on-1's, coworker reviews, company presentations, and brainstorming sessions using various methods to share knowledge, give and take critique to set goals, and allow everyone to become invested in the creative process and bring forth the best ideas.

Experienced in creating design specs and walking stakeholders through the design vision.

Experienced with F2P best practices, systems, core loops, and content pipelines, always keeping abreast of the latest developments with competing products, platform hardware, and storefronts.

Experienced in creating holistic features, that compliment each other, bridge meta and core game, and dovetail with the player's motivations across their entire player journey.

Employment History

Senior Designer – Pixel Toys; Leamington Spa, United Kingdom
8/20 – 12/25

Feature owner working across multiple pods on a new, unannounced mobile game.

Accomplishments:

Created designs based on product goals and ensured alignment on acceptance criteria.

Developed data sheets and validation criteria so our content and live ops teams could create new events and upload them to our servers for testing.

Worked with production to set sprint goals for my pods to keep on track for our milestones.

Researched best in class competitors and evolved features as necessary to meet our product goals.

Led features through our development process, working with design, UX, art, and the dev team to arrive at a finished, quality product.

Held feedback meetings to walk stakeholders through the latest game builds to keep all stakeholders up to date and identify areas of further iteration.

Designer – Wooga; Berlin, Germany
8/16 – 7/20

Joined the June's Journey team due to my expertise with hidden object games. Focused on feature ownership and our weekly content pipeline. June's Journey success led to Wooga's sale to Playtika.

Accomplishments:

Joined June's Journey team during soft launch, focusing on content and features. Feature owner of guild versus guild competitions, expansion of our meta game post original end-of-content, toast notifications, player profile, and leaderboard. Continually developed features and pitched 1-pagers alongside our weekly content release schedule.

As part of the guild versus guild competition, developed two additional brand new games modes (Spot the Difference and Time Rush) and modeled out scenarios for balancing.

Owned and developed best practices for our monthly seasonal decoration balancing

and planning, working closely with art, live ops, and our data team.
Worked with our data and product team to set success targets for various features and our monthly seasonal decoration events.
Regularly ran user tests on WIP features and content, using paper prototypes, test builds, and services such as PlaytestCloud.
Addressed outstanding issues in our core loop by working with our art and design lead to create a year-long roadmap for decoration creation, giving the player a path to progress and providing our players with multiple themes and styles to create their dream island.
Onboarded new designers on to the team, greatly increasing our throughput, and trained them in specific features, like the decoration planning, balancing, and configuration to promote knowledge sharing and balance workload.
Gave presentations to the company covering our core loop improvements and feature development.

Designer - pixelStorm Entertainment Studios Inc.; Edmonton, AB, Canada
7/10 - 12/15

Wore many hats in a small team environment. Initially, primarily focused on design in hidden object games. Then transitioning to more general game dev, creating prototypes in Unity and Game Maker.

Accomplishments:

Developed iOS and Android games from prototype to release, using Unity (C#) and Game Maker.

Created systems and content encompassing story, dialog, puzzles, minigames, features, and general gameplay to help our Hidden Object games stand out in a competitive field and garner rave reviews.

Scripted and created placeholder assets for full whiteboxes of walkthroughs using our proprietary game engine, to test design ideas and game flow before committing art resources.

Designer - Sensory Sweep Studios; West Valley City, UT, USA
5/07 - 3/09

Worked with teams of various sizes in a Scrum style development environment. As a core team member, laid the groundwork for game content and design for projects in pre-production.

Accomplishments:

Joined midway through development of the "My (French/Spanish) Coach" games and took over responsibilities in minigame design, player progression, and documentation, helping establish a strong foundation on which we could build for the sequel "My (Chinese/Japanese) Coach" games.

Designed and built (using in-engine tools) the FTUE experience for the "My Coach" games.

Collaborated with team in the creation and implementation of front end UI, in-game world maps, quest system, levels, map tools, and DS/Wii specific systems and minigames for Eagle Summoner.

Established, documented, and taught best practices to design team for design of Eagle Summoner levels, resulting in the successful submission and review of hundreds of quality levels.

Education

The Illinois Institute of Art-Chicago; Chicago, IL, USA
1/04 - 3/06

B.F.A. With Honors in Game Art and Design

Related Coursework: Scriptwriting & Storytelling, Programming for the Artist, Game Prototyping

University of North Carolina Asheville; Asheville, NC, USA
8/02 - 12/03 & 1/07 - 4/07

Dean's List Fall 2003, Related Coursework: Creative Writing, General Psychology

Skills

Extensively experienced in various aspects of design including system design, economy design, level design, UI, analytics, monetization, writing (features,

narrative), event scripting

Coding, scripting, and implementation of game in engines such as Unity (C#)

Proficient with Google Sheets, JIRA, Confluence, Trello, Miro, Figma, and Photoshop

Applicable Shipped Titles

June's Journey, Bubble Island 2, Blocky Kong, Luna Bears: Valentine's Fun, Super Skyland, Mystery Legends: Beauty and the Beast & Mystery Legends: Phantom of the Opera